office was limited to the tribe of the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH). Hence to solve this crisis, Timur did something very different (later his successor Abu'l-Fath Jalal-ud-din Muhammad Akbar would do something similar in the sixteenth century). Timur got a myth formulized and portrayed himself as a 'supernatural personal power' ordained by God (say, Allah).[§] Interestingly and radically enough, this myth was propagated that he was a spiritual descendant of Ali, thus linking his lineage to both Genghis Khān and the Quraysh.[¶]

So, this makes the narrative clear that Timur aspired to become powerful by hook or by crook. He wanted to be known as the head of all humanity without compromising on principles laid by Prophet Muhammad (PBUH).

This sets the precedent very correctly for Babur, who established a 'Tīmūrid Empire' in India to push for not only Islamism but also to retain control over the Mongols. He simply meant business and being a follower of Timur, he would not shy away from inflating and using religion whenever required.

Perhaps intolerance was a part of their conduct and it would be dishonest to expect the progenies of Timur to begin a new chapter of tolerance. If one understands 'Timur', it will not be tough to get into the psyche of the politics of Babur and his successors. Not to forget, the history of Timur had a strong impact on Babur.

Before this project of books on the Tīmūrid Gūrkāniyān, I deep-dived into the lives of Babur, Humayun, Akbar and Aurangzeb. Their religious and economic policies were very clearer to me, but as research progressed, a lot opened even about Jahangir and Shah Jahan. It was quite astonishing for me to discover that Jahangir began his tourney as the king of the Tīmūrid Empire, who was intolerant towards non-Muslims. Earlier the Jahangir's image was known to me as the 'Salim' of *Mughal-e-Azam*, but the historical records didn't agree with my impression of him. The maiden *farmans* of him indicated very strongly that he wanted to make his empire a hardcore *Islamist* one. Although people talk of his drug and alcohol addictions, with fervour to show how distant he was from Islam in his own words, he had asked the *Ulemas* to prepare a set of 'idiosyncratic appeals to Allah' which he could easily remember and repeat without any disturbance on his rosary. His sadistic nature is also well-recorded in his writings. When he went to war against Mewar, he declared it to be a *qital fi sabilillah*.[*] Many mandirs were destroyed in this campaign. Similar emotions reigned high in his Kangra Campaign of AD 1621. His aggression against the Sikh Guru Arjan Dev too is very well recorded. Guru Arjan Dev was killed after being brutally tortured by Jahangir. Jahangir's ill-treatment of Guru Arjan Dev's successor, Guru Hargobind, too is well recorded.[†]